1. ConvertAudioEngine-Keep71.ps1 *(audio-processing script)*

Retains TrueHD 7.1 and AAC 7.1 audio tracks

- Add a **DDP 5.1 (EAC3) compatibility track** for universal playback
- Downmix all other >5.1 audio to **DDP 5.1 (1024k)**
- Re-encode 5.1 audio to **DDP 5.1 (768k)**
- Encode stereo audio to **DDP 2.0 (256k)**
- Maintain perfect sync on long-duration files
- Normalize malformed channel layouts
- Remove 2-channel commentary tracks
- Produce clean, predictable, device-safe output

Requirements

- **PowerShell** 5.1 or 7.x (fully tested on both)
- **FFmpeg 8.1 or newer** — Must be in your PATH or the same folder as the script. You can grab the latest builds from the official FFmpeg download page: **https://ffmpeg.org/download.html**

1. Place `ConvertAudioEngine-Keep71.ps1`, `ffmpeg.exe`, and `ffprobe.exe` in the same folder.
2. Run the script:

> *powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\ConvertAudioEngine-Keep71.ps1 ".\YourMovie.mkv"*

ℹ️ The -ExecutionPolicy Bypass only applies to this single run and doesn't change your system settings.

🎧 Supported Audio Codecs

The engine supports and processes the following codec families:

Codec Family	Formats Included
AAC	AAC LC, HE-AAC, AAC 5.1, AAC 7.1
EAC3 / Atmos	EAC3, EAC3-JOC (Atmos)
TrueHD	TrueHD 5.1, TrueHD 7.1, TrueHD+Atmos
DTS	DTS Core, DTS-HD MA, DTS-HD HRA
PCM	pcm*s16le, pcm*s24le, pcm*f32le, pcm*f32be
FLAC	All FLAC channel layouts

2. FFmpeg Global Options:

These are global flags to ensure FFmpeg handles large, high-resolution files without data corruption or sync drift.

- `-threads 8` * User-adjustable (4–16), 0 = automatic
  - **What:** Sets the number of CPU threads the encoder is allowed to use.
    - **Why:** Helps balance encoding speed and system stability. It prevents CPU saturation that can lead to frame drops or system instability during the muxing process.
- `-analyzeduration 200M & -probesize 200M`
  - **What:** Increases the initial data analysis buffer to 200 Megabytes.
    - **Why:** High-bitrate audio like TrueHD with Atmos metadata or AAC 7.1 requires a deep probe to fully parse the channel layout. Standard 5MB, 10MB, 20MB probes often misidentify these tracks, causing the encode to fail or use the wrong channel map.
- `-err_detect ignore_err`
  - **What:** Instructs FFmpeg to bypass minor bitstream errors.
    - **Why:** Prevents a single corrupted audio frame (common in digital rips) from aborting a multi-hour conversion process.
- `-drc_scale 0`
  - **What:** Disables Dynamic Range Compression (DRC).
    - **Why:** Ensures the output audio maintains the full dynamic range of the source. It prevents the encoder from "flattening" the sound or lowering the volume of loud peaks.
- `-i $InputFile`
  - **What:** Specifies the source file path.
    - **Why:** Acts as the primary input for the FFmpeg engine to begin the probing and mapping sequence.

3. The "De-Sync" Safeguard

These flags are applied after the input to maintain perfect alignment on long-duration files.

- `-avoid_negative_ts make_zero`
  - **What:** Forces all stream timestamps to start at absolute zero.
    - **Why:** Many digital files contain negative initial "Presentation Time Stamps" (PTS); this clamps them to zero to prevent audio lag or lead.
- `-max_muxing_queue_size 14000` *(1024-100000) recommended range
  - **What:** Increases the muxing buffer headroom.
    - **Why:** Pass+Copy mode creates 3 streams (video c, 7.1 pass, 7.1→EAC3 enc). One copy (video) and one pass (7.1 audio) streams flood the muxer while the encode pipeline catches up; 14000 buffer prevents de-sync on 3+ hour files.
- `-map 0:v? -c:v copy`
  - **What:** Maps all video tracks and sets them to stream-copy mode.
    - **Why:** Ensures zero quality loss for the video while moving at maximum speed.

- `-map_metadata 0 -map_chapters 0`
  - **What:** Copies global metadata and chapter markers from the source.
    - **Why:** Preserves the original file's organizational structure (Title, Year, Scene markers).

4. Stereo (2.0) Optimization: Dolby Pro Logic II Compatibility

For stereo tracks, the engine uses specific flags to ensure they playback correctly on both standard speakers and surround sound systems.

- **-dsur_mode 1**
  - **What:** Enables the Dolby Surround Mode flag in the EAC3 bitstream.
    - **Why:** Tells the playback receiver that the 2.0 track contains matrixed surround information (like Pro Logic II), allowing it to properly expand the soundstage.
- **-stereo_rematrixing 1**
  - **What:** Explicitly enables rematrixing during the stereo encode.
    - **Why:** Ensures that the left and right channels are balanced correctly during the conversion from higher-channel sources to stereo.

5. Encoding & Downmix Execution

These parameters determine how the audio is shaped and processed during encoding.

- **-filter:a:$i $panFilter**
  - **What:** Applies the custom channel-mapping matrix (the Pan Filter).
    - **Why:** Necessary for downmixing 7.1 or 5.1 to smaller layouts. It ensures that "lost" channels (like back-surrounds) are projected into the remaining speakers rather than simply deleted.
- **-c:a:$i eac3**
  - **What:** Sets the codec for audio stream `$i` to Dolby Digital Plus (EAC3).
    - **Why:** Chosen for its high efficiency and broad compatibility with modern smart TVs and home theater receivers.
- **-b:a:$i $t.Bitrate**
  - **What:** Sets the target bitrate (e.g., 1024k for 5.1, 256k for 2.0).
    - **Why:** High bitrates ensure the "transparency" of the encode, making it difficult to distinguish from the lossless original.
- **-dialnorm -31**
  - **What:** Sets Dialogue Normalization to the reference "off" position.
    - **Why:** Prevents the playback device from applying its own internal volume leveling, preserving the original mix's intended loudness.

- **-cutoff 20000**
  - **What:** Sets the low-pass filter frequency to 20kHz.
    - **Why:** Preserves the high-frequency "clarity" of the audio that standard encoders sometimes discard to save space.
    - **Applies to:** Downmix, 5.1 re-encode, and Pass+Copy DDP duplicate paths. Not applied to the stereo (2.0) encode path.
- **-metadata:s:a:$i "title=..."**
  - **What:** Injects a custom string into the stream title metadata.
    - **Why:** Allows users to see exactly what the track is (e.g., "DD+ 5.1 Downmix") in their media player's audio selection menu.

6. Audio Rules & Priority

The audio-engine uses a **Priority Mapping (0-110)** to evaluate tracks based on quality and codec type.

The "Pass+Copy" Strategy

- **Action:** Specifically for **TrueHD 7.1** and **AAC 7.1**.
- **What:** It performs a **Passthrough** of the original 7.1 master while creating a **new EAC3 (DD+) 5.1** duplicate at **1024k**.
- **Why:** This future-proofs the file for high-end theaters while providing a high-quality fallback for standard devices that cannot decode 7.1 layouts.
- **Summary Visualization:** This action generates **two rows** in the final summary report for a single input track:
  - **Row 1:** The original 7.1 Passthrough (Master).
    - **Row 2:** The new DDP 5.1 Copy (Compatibility track).

TrueHD Rules (Priority 110)

Channels	Action	Output
8ch (7.1)	Pass+Copy	TrueHD 7.1 + DDP 5.1 @ 1024k
6ch (5.1)	**Passthrough**	Original TrueHD 5.1

EAC3 / Atmos Rules (Priority 100)

Condition	Action	Output	Notes
Atmos (JOC)	Passthrough	Original EAC3 Atmos	Preserves object metadata.
EAC3 7.1	**Downmix**	DDP 5.1 @ 1024k	Pri 99: Maps 8 channels to 6 using Pan Filter.
EAC3 5.1	Passthrough	Original EAC3 5.1	No re-encode needed.
EAC3 2.0	Passthrough	Original EAC3 2.0	No re-encode needed.

AAC Rules (Priority 93)

Channels	Action	Output
8ch (7.1)	Pass+Copy	AAC 7.1 + DDP 5.1 @ 1024k
6ch (5.1)	Encode	DDP 5.1 @ 768k
2ch (2.0)	Encode	DDP 2.0 @ 256k
Malformed AAC 7ch	> forced to 6ch** before rule matching.	

DTS Rules (Priority 73)

Variant	Action	Output
DTS-HD MA/HRA (multichannel)	Encode	DDP 5.1 @ 1024k
DTS Core (multichannel)	Encode	DDP 5.1 @ 768k
DTS-HD 2.0	**Encode**	DDP 2.0 @ 384k
DTS 2.0	Encode	DDP 2.0 @ 256k

PCM / FLAC Rules (Priority 62)

Channels	Action	Output
8ch (7.1)	Downmix	DDP 5.1 @ 1024k
6ch (5.1)	Encode	DDP 5.1 @ 768k
2ch (2.0)	Encode	DDP 2.0 @ 384k

Master Codec Rules

Priority	Feature/Codec	Action	Why?
110	**TrueHD 7.1**	Pass+Copy	Preserves lossless master + adds compatible fallback.
100	**EAC3 Atmos**	Passthrough	Keeps Atmos metadata intact for object-based audio.
93	**AAC 7.1**	Pass+Copy	Keeps high-channel source + adds DDP 5.1 duplicate.
73	**DTS-HD**	Encode	Converts high-bitrate DTS to EAC3 5.1 for compatibility.
0	**Commentary**	Removed	Filters out unwanted 2.0 director/cast tracks to save space.

⛔ Fallback Rules

If no specific rule matches, the following logic is applied:

Channels	Action	Bitrate
≤2ch	Encode	256k
3–6ch	Encode	768k
>6ch	Downmix	1024k

7. Spatial Audio: The Pan Filter Matrix

When 7.1 audio is reduced to 5.1, standard downmixing often loses spatial detail from the side channels.

The Formula

> *aformat=channel_layouts=7.1,pan=5.1|FL=FL|FR=FR|FC=FC|LFE=LFE|BL=BL+0.707SL|>BR=BR+0.707SR,alimiter=limit=0.948:attack=5:release=50:level=disabled*

Layout Locking (aformat)

What: Forces the decoder to output a strict 8-channel 7.1 layout *before* the Pan Filter runs.
Why: Some codecs (TrueHD, AAC, EAC3) may decode into non-standard 7.1 variants.
Locking the layout ensures:

- SL really is the Side Left channel
- BL really is the Back Left channel
- No channel swapping
- No silent corruption of the downmix

The Math (0.707)

What: Applies a –3 dB coefficient to the Side Surrounds (SL/SR).
Why: Prevents the side channels from overpowering the rear soundstage and avoids digital clipping.

Limiter (0.948) — For All 7.1 Codecs

alimiter=limit=0.948:attack=5:release=50:level=disabled Why: Any 7.1 track that is downmixed or duplicated into 5.1 can produce true-peak overshoots after decoding:

- AAC 7.1 > when creating the DDP 5.1 copy
- TrueHD 7.1 > when creating the DDP 5.1 copy
- DTS-HD MA > during 7.1 → 5.1 downmix
- PCM/FLAC > during 7.1 → 5.1 downmix
- EAC3 7.1 > during 7.1 → 5.1 downmix

Important:

- If the source audio already contains true-peak or inter-sample peaks ("clips"), these will also appear in **analysis** of the downmix.

- The limiter prevents new clipping during downmixing and encoding, but **it does not remove overshoots inherent in the source mix**.

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8. Commentary Filtering

Only 2-channel commentary tracksare removed to save space while preserving primary content.

- **Detection Methods:** Title matching, keyword detection, and case-insensitive search.
- **Keywords:** `commentary, director, producer, writer, cast, behind, bonus, alt, interview`.
- **Why 5.1 Commentary is NOT removed:**
  - It is extremely rare in retail media.
    - It is often hard to tell apart from legitimate "Alternate Mixes" or "Home Theater Optimized" tracks.
    - Removing it carries a high risk of "False Positives" (deleting real movie content).

9. Malformed Layout Guards

The script corrects illegal 7-channel layouts:

- **AAC 7ch** → 6ch, **EAC3 7ch** → 6ch,
- **TrueHD 7ch** → 8ch, **PCM/FLAC 7ch** → 8ch
- **Dialnorm (-31):** Sets Dialogue Normalization to -31dB. This is the "off" setting for Dolby metadata, preventing the playback device from applying its own "loudness leveling" and ensuring you hear the audio exactly as encoded.

10. Summary Report

At =Audio processing Summary =, the script generates a detailed table with the following columns:

- For Pass+Copy tracks, "--Copy" appears as Action and output identifies it as the DDP 5.1.

Column	Description
Index	The original stream number (e.g., 1, 2).
Codec	The source format (e.g., TrueHD, DTS).
Channels	The detected number of channels (e.g., 7.1, 5.1).
Action	**Green**: Passthrough, **Yellow**: Downmix, **Blue**: Encode, **Red**: Removed.
Output	The final codec and bitrate configuration.
Priority	The assigned priority level, ranging from 0 to 110.
Rule	the logical rule that was matched during processing, such as "TrueHD 7.1 Rule"

11. Non-Critical FFmpeg Warnings (Safe to Ignore)

During processing, FFmpeg may display one or more of the following messages.
These warnings are **normal**, and do not affect audio quality, sync, or re-encode.
They come from FFmpeg's internal decoders and subtitle parsers — not from the script!

"quant*step*size larger than huff_lsbs"

- **Cause:** Printed by the TrueHD decoder during the initial probe phase.
- **Impact:** Safe to ignore. Does not affect decoding, channel layout, or the Pass+Copy path.

"Codec AVOption drc_scale ... has not been used for any stream"

- **Cause:** (`-drc_scale`) applies only to AC-3/EAC3 decoders.

  FFmpeg prints this when the input track is not AC-3 (e.g., TrueHD, DTS, FLAC).
- **Impact:** Safe to ignore. The script disables DRC intentionally for consistent output.

"(Subtitle: hdmv*pgs*subtitle) unspecified size"

- **Cause:** PGS (Blu-ray) subtitles do not declare width/height in the container.

  FFmpeg warns until the first subtitle packet is decoded.
- **Impact:** Safe to ignore. Subtitles are copied untouched (`-c:s copy`).

"Assuming an incorrectly encoded 7.1 channel layout...instead of 7.1(wide)"

- **Cause:** AAC has two 7.1 layouts. Most encoders use the common (non-spec) layout.

  FFmpeg prints this when the file does not use the strict 7.1(wide) AAC layout.
- **Impact:** Safe to ignore. The script already corrects and pins the layout using (`aformat=channel_layouts=7.1`)

Disclaimer

- Although the audio-engine includes safeguards for long-duration and high-bitrate audio, results can vary depending on the source files and system hardware.
- Always test it on a few movie files first before running it on your whole library.
- Always keep backups of your original files.